

PRIZED PRINCE

Karan Singh



Through agreements between the Centre and the state of Jammu and Kashmir, the title and power of the *Sadar-i-Riyasat*, Karan Singh, had been abolished. In exchange, Singh became a Central Cabinet minister in 1973, in charge of Tourism and Aviation. Because of the special status of J&K and his lineage, Singh became a prominent member of Prime Minister Indira Gandhi's cabinet and was soon elevated to the better Ministry of Health and Family Planning. In 1974, he made headlines when he said at the first-ever World Population Conference, "Development is the best contraceptive."

● President Nixon announced the suspension of all US offensive action in Vietnam, claiming to "bring peace with



HEADY ROMANCE

Scripted by K.A. Abbas and outfitted by Bhanu Athaiya, *Bobby* became the epitome of youthful cool at a turbulent time. As Madhu Jain wrote, there was mass hysteria when *Bobby* was released, with "teenagers sporting shirts with Bobby written on them". *Main shayar to nahin* and *Hum tum ek kamre mein band hon* defined puppy love.



honour" (above).

- Oil prices almost quadrupled following the Yom Kippur war as Arab countries cut down on oil exports to the West. Japan and the US faced severe oil shortages.
- Sheikh Mujibur Rehman and the Awami League won a landslide victory in the first elections in Bangladesh.
- Artist Pablo Picasso died of a heart attack at his home in France.

Reaping Reward

The Food and Agriculture Organisation of the UN presented Indira Gandhi with the Ceres medal in recognition of the advances made in the Green Revolution.

1,827

was the number of tigers in the country in 1972. Project Tiger was launched in 1973 to protect the species.

10,800

trains of the Indian Railways were in operation, covering a route length of 60,234 km.